CONSULT FOR AFRICA

C1: Medicine and the Hospital

The CFA MBA, Term 1

Workbook for Ezinne Orji and Abigail Oladejo

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How to use this workbook

Week	Dates	Section	Test
1	9 to 13 Nov	How medical words are built	Test 1
2	16 to 20 Nov	The body by system I	Test 2
3	23 to 27 Nov	The body by system II	Test 3
4	30 Nov to 4 Dec	Who does what, and how they write it down	Test 4
5	7 to 11 Dec	Tests, scans, theatre and procedures	Test 5
6	14 to 18 Dec	How a patient moves and how money moves	Test 6
Exam	Thu 7 Jan	Written paper and oral	

- Before week 1: the Care Coordinator Safety Card. It applies on every Mezo request from today.
- Each week: read the section, including its Mezo section, add every term in the tables to your glossary, do the pair drill, do the exercise, take the test on Friday closed book.
- Spelling: Nigerian hospitals write British English. Haemoglobin, anaemia, oesophagus, paediatrics, gynaecology, orthopaedics, oedema, diarrhoea. American spellings in a CFA document are errors.
- All patient documents in this workbook are invented for training. No real patient appears.

Week 1: How medical words are built

1.1 The method

Most medical terms are built from three parts: a prefix at the front, a root in the middle, and a suffix at the end. Learn about 150 parts and you can decode thousands of words.

Term	Broken down	Meaning
Gastritis	gastr (stomach) + itis (inflammation)	Inflammation of the stomach
Hysterectomy	hyster (uterus) + ectomy (removal)	Removal of the uterus
Bradycardia	brady (slow) + cardi (heart) + ia (condition)	Slow heart rate
Arthroplasty	arthr (joint) + plasty (surgical repair)	Joint replacement or repair
Nephrology	nephr (kidney) + logy (study of)	The specialty of kidney medicine

- Read from the end: the suffix usually tells you what kind of thing it is (a disease, an operation, a test). Then the root tells you where. Then the prefix tells you how much, which side, or when.
- Combining vowel: an "o" is often added to join parts: gastr + o + scopy = gastroscopy.

1.2 Prefixes

Prefix	Meaning	Example
a, an	without, absence of	Anaemia (lack of blood), apnoea (no breathing)

Prefix	Meaning	Example
ante, pre	before	Antenatal, pre-operative
post	after	Postnatal, post-operative
brady	slow	Bradycardia
tachy	fast	Tachycardia
dys	difficult, abnormal	Dysmenorrhoea (painful periods), dysphagia (difficulty swallowing)
hyper	above, excessive	Hypertension, hyperglycaemia
hypo	below, deficient	Hypoglycaemia, hypothyroidism
endo	within	Endoscopy, endometrium
epi	upon, over	Epidural, epigastric
peri	around	Pericardium, perinatal
intra	within	Intravenous, intramuscular
inter	between	Intercostal (between the ribs)
sub	under	Subcutaneous
supra	above	Suprapubic
trans	across, through	Transfusion, transvaginal
retro	behind	Retroperitoneal
neo	new	Neonate, neoplasm
poly	many	Polyuria (passing a lot of urine)
oligo	few, scanty	Oligohydramnios, oligospermia
hemi	half	Hemiplegia (paralysis of one side)
micro, macro	small, large	Microcephaly, macrosomia (a large baby)
anti, contra	against	Antibiotic, contraception
uni, bi, tri	one, two, three	Bilateral (both sides)

1.3 Roots

Root	Meaning	Example
cardi	heart	Cardiology
angi, vas	vessel	Angiogram, vascular
arteri	artery	Arteriosclerosis

Root	Meaning	Example
phleb, ven	vein	Phlebotomy (drawing blood), venous
haem, haemat	blood	Haematology, haemorrhage
thromb	clot	Thrombosis
pneum, pulmon	lung, air	Pneumonia, pulmonary
bronch	airway	Bronchitis
rhin	nose	Rhinitis
laryng	voice box	Laryngoscopy
gastr	stomach	Gastroenterology
enter	small intestine	Enteritis
col	colon, large bowel	Colonoscopy
hepat	liver	Hepatitis
chole	bile, gallbladder	Cholecystectomy
nephr, ren	kidney	Nephrology, renal
cyst	bladder, sac	Cystoscopy
ur	urine	Urology
neur	nerve	Neurology
encephal, cerebr	brain	Encephalitis, cerebral
oste	bone	Osteoporosis
arthr	joint	Arthritis
my	muscle	Myalgia (muscle pain)
spondyl, vertebr	spine	Spondylosis
derm, cutane	skin	Dermatology, subcutaneous
gyn, gynaec	woman	Gynaecology
hyster, metr	uterus	Hysteroscopy, endometriosis
oophor	ovary	Oophorectomy
salping	fallopian tube	Salpingectomy
mamm, mast	breast	Mammogram, mastectomy
obstetr	pregnancy and birth	Obstetrics
paed	child	Paediatrics

Root	Meaning	Example
ger	old age	Geriatrics
onc	tumour, cancer	Oncology
carcin	cancer	Carcinoma
path	disease	Pathology
cyt	cell	Cytology
aden	gland	Adenoma
thyr	thyroid	Thyroidectomy
glyc	sugar	Glycaemia
lip	fat	Liposuction
ophthalm, ocul	eye	Ophthalmology, ocular
ot	ear	Otitis
odont, dent	tooth	Orthodontics, dental
psych	mind	Psychiatry
crani	skull	Craniotomy
lymph	lymph	Lymphoma
myel	bone marrow, spinal cord	Myeloma

1.4 Suffixes

Suffix	Meaning	Example
itis	inflammation	Appendicitis
osis	abnormal condition	Thrombosis
oma	tumour, swelling	Fibroma, lipoma
pathy	disease of	Neuropathy, cardiomyopathy
algia	pain	Arthralgia
aemia	blood condition	Anaemia, septicaemia
megaly	enlargement	Hepatomegaly, cardiomegaly
penia	deficiency	Thrombocytopenia (low platelets)
rrhage	bursting forth	Haemorrhage
rrhoea	flow, discharge	Diarrhoea, amenorrhoea

Suffix	Meaning	Example
plegia	paralysis	Paraplegia
ectomy	surgical removal	Appendicectomy, myomectomy
otomy	cutting into	Laparotomy (opening the abdomen)
ostomy	making an opening	Colostomy, tracheostomy
plasty	surgical repair or reshaping	Rhinoplasty, abdominoplasty
pexy	fixing in place	Mastopexy (breast lift)
scopy	looking inside with a scope	Endoscopy, laparoscopy
gram	the image or record	Mammogram, electrocardiogram
graphy	the process of recording	Ultrasonography
centesis	drawing off fluid with a needle	Amniocentesis
logy, logist	study of, specialist	Cardiology, cardiologist
iatrics, iatry	medical treatment	Paediatrics, psychiatry
genic	caused by	Iatrogenic (caused by treatment)

1.5 Words that trip people up

- Ectomy, otomy, ostomy: removing it, cutting into it, making a permanent opening. A laparotomy opens the abdomen; a colectomy removes the colon; a colostomy brings the colon out to the skin.
- Ileum and ilium: the ileum is part of the small bowel; the ilium is part of the pelvic bone.
- Prostate and prostrate: the prostate is a gland; prostrate means lying face down.
- Perineal and peritoneal: the perineum is between the legs; the peritoneum lines the abdomen.
- Aesthetic and anaesthetic: cosmetic work, and the drug that removes sensation.
- Mucus and mucous: mucus is the noun; mucous membrane is the adjective.

1.6 Pair drill

Dictate 20 terms from the tables above to each other. The listener spells the word aloud, breaks it into parts, and gives the meaning. Swap.

1.7 Exercise 1

Take the last three sets of meeting notes or emails you wrote that touch a client. List every medical term in them. For each: the parts, the meaning, and whether you spelled it correctly. If there are fewer than ten, use the Arabella and Haven engagement notes on the platform instead.

On the Mezo line: the request note

Patients describe symptoms in their own words. Record their words first, then the clinical terms, then the duration. Never correct or confirm a caller's own diagnosis; record it as "caller believes".

Caller says	Usually means	Write
"My body is hot"	Fever	Fever
"I have been stooling"	Diarrhoea	Diarrhoea x 3/7
"I have BP"	Hypertension	Known hypertensive
"I have sugar"	Diabetes	Known diabetic
"My eyes are turning"	Dizziness	Dizziness
"Catarrh"	Nasal congestion, runny nose	Nasal congestion
"Waist pain"	Lower back pain	Low back pain
"Ulcer"	Often any upper abdominal pain	Epigastric pain; caller believes ulcer
"Pile"	Sometimes haemorrhoids, sometimes vague abdominal or anal symptoms	Ask where, then record
"Malaria and typhoid"	A self-diagnosis	Caller believes malaria and typhoid; symptoms: ...

Example: Caller says "my belly has been turning and I have been stooling water since Tuesday". Note: abdominal discomfort and watery diarrhoea x 3/7. Red flags screened: no blood, drinking fluids, not drowsy.

1.8 Test 1

Closed book, 25 minutes. Paste your answers on the task.

1. Break down and define: cholecystectomy.
2. Break down and define: hepatomegaly.
3. Break down and define: dysphagia.
4. Break down and define: thrombocytopenia.
5. Break down and define: salpingectomy.
6. What is the difference between a colectomy and a colostomy?
7. What does the prefix "tachy" mean? Give one word that uses it.
8. What does the suffix "plasty" mean? Give one word that uses it.
9. Name the specialist who treats the kidneys.
10. What does "iatrogenic" mean?
11. Write the British spelling of: anemia, pediatrics, esophagus, edema.
12. What is a neoplasm?
13. What is the root for uterus? Give two.
14. What does "bilateral" mean?
15. What does "laparoscopy" mean?
16. What is the difference between the ileum and the ilium?
17. Build the word for inflammation of the joint.
18. Build the word for the removal of the breast.

19. Build the word for slow heart rate.
20. Spell five terms your partner dictates.
21. A caller says: "My body has been hot and I have been stooling since Sunday." Today is Wednesday. Write the request note line.
22. A caller says: "I have BP and sugar." What does the caller mean, and what do you write?

Week 2: The body by system I

For each system: what it does, the vocabulary, the conditions you will hear about most in Nigerian hospitals, and the specialist.

2.1 Heart and circulation (cardiovascular)

- What it does: the heart pumps blood through arteries to the body and back through veins.
- Specialist: cardiologist (medical); cardiothoracic surgeon (surgical).

Term	Meaning
Hypertension (HTN)	High blood pressure. The most common chronic condition in Nigerian adult clinics.
Blood pressure (BP)	Written as two numbers, for example 140/90 mmHg: systolic over diastolic
Myocardial infarction (MI)	Heart attack: heart muscle dies from blocked blood supply
Heart failure (CCF, CHF)	The heart cannot pump enough. CCF is congestive cardiac failure.
Arrhythmia	Abnormal heart rhythm
Stroke (CVA)	Cerebrovascular accident: brain damage from a blocked or burst blood vessel
Deep vein thrombosis (DVT)	A clot in a deep vein, usually the leg. A known risk after surgery.
Electrocardiogram (ECG)	Recording of the heart's electrical activity
Echocardiogram (echo)	Ultrasound of the heart

2.2 Lungs and breathing (respiratory)

- Specialist: pulmonologist or chest physician.

Term	Meaning
Asthma	Narrowing of the airways in episodes
Pneumonia	Infection of the lung tissue
Tuberculosis (TB, PTB)	Bacterial infection, PTB when it is in the lungs. A notifiable disease.
COPD	Chronic obstructive pulmonary disease
Upper respiratory tract infection (URTI)	Colds, sore throats, sinus infections
Dyspnoea, SOB	Difficulty breathing, shortness of breath
SpO2	Oxygen saturation, measured with a clip on the finger. Normal is roughly 95% or higher.

2.3 Gut and liver (digestive, gastrointestinal)

- Specialists: gastroenterologist (medical, does endoscopies); general surgeon (surgical).

Term	Meaning
Peptic ulcer disease (PUD)	Ulcers in the stomach or duodenum
GORD	Gastro-oesophageal reflux disease, acid reflux. GERD in American usage.
Hepatitis B and C	Viral liver infections. HBsAg is the hepatitis B screening test.
Cirrhosis	Scarring of the liver
Appendicitis	Inflamed appendix, usually an emergency operation
Haemorrhoids	Swollen veins at the anus, called piles
Upper GI endoscopy, gastroscopy	Camera into the stomach through the mouth
Colonoscopy	Camera into the large bowel

2.4 Kidneys and urinary system (renal, urology)

- Specialists: nephrologist (medical, runs dialysis); urologist (surgical).

Term	Meaning
Chronic kidney disease (CKD)	Long-term loss of kidney function. Often follows hypertension or diabetes.
Acute kidney injury (AKI)	Sudden loss of kidney function
Dialysis	A machine does the kidneys' filtering. Haemodialysis is usually three sessions a week.
Urinary tract infection (UTI)	Infection of the bladder or kidneys
Benign prostatic hyperplasia (BPH)	Enlarged prostate, common in older men
Renal transplant	Kidney transplant

2.5 Blood (haematology)

- Specialist: haematologist.

Term	Meaning
Anaemia	Low haemoglobin. Measured as Hb or PCV.
Sickle cell disease (SCD)	Inherited blood disorder. Genotype SS. Crises cause severe pain.
Genotype	AA, AS, SS, AC and others. Tested before marriage and in children.
Blood transfusion	Giving donated blood, measured in units or pints
Malaria	Parasite infection carried by mosquitoes. Tested by MP (malaria parasite) film or RDT (rapid test).

Term	Meaning
Leukaemia, lymphoma, myeloma	Cancers of blood cells, lymph tissue and bone marrow plasma cells

2.6 Hormones (endocrine)

- Specialist: endocrinologist.

Term	Meaning
Diabetes mellitus (DM)	Raised blood sugar. Type 1 (no insulin made), type 2 (insulin not working well).
HbA1c	Average blood sugar over about three months
FBS, RBS	Fasting blood sugar, random blood sugar
Hypoglycaemia	Dangerously low blood sugar
Thyroid disease	Hyperthyroidism (overactive), hypothyroidism (underactive), goitre (enlarged gland)

2.7 Pair drill

Each of you names a condition from this week; the other gives the system, the specialist who treats it and one test used to diagnose it.

2.8 Exercise 2

Pick three conditions from this week. For each, write two lines a hospital owner would recognise: what it is in plain English, and why it matters to a hospital's business (for example: dialysis is a fixed schedule of repeat visits, so it brings steady revenue and needs reliable power and water).

On the Mezo line: matching to a specialist, system I

Screen for red flags first, every time (Safety Card). Then match.

Caller's need	Book
High blood pressure, needs control; palpitations	Cardiologist, or a physician (internal medicine)
Cough over two weeks, weight loss, night sweats	Chest physician (pulmonologist)
Heartburn, stomach pain, needs an endoscopy	Gastroenterologist
Blood in stool, haemorrhoids needing surgery	General surgeon, or gastroenterologist first
Raised creatinine, kidney disease, dialysis	Nephrologist
Difficulty passing urine (older man), kidney stones	Urologist
Sickle cell disease follow-up, unexplained anaemia	Haematologist
Diabetes, thyroid problems	Endocrinologist
Several problems, or not sure	Physician (internal medicine) or family physician. Do not guess at a sub-specialist.

- Chest pain, breathlessness or collapse: emergency first, never a clinic booking.

2.9 Test 2

1. What do the two numbers in a blood pressure reading mean?
2. What is an MI?
3. What is CVA another name for?
4. What does an echocardiogram show?
5. Which specialist performs a colonoscopy?
6. What does HBsAg test for?
7. Expand GORD and say what it is.
8. Expand CKD. Name two conditions that commonly lead to it.
9. What is the difference between a nephrologist and a urologist?
10. What genotype does a person with sickle cell disease usually have?
11. What two tests are used for malaria?
12. What does HbA1c measure?
13. What is the difference between FBS and RBS?
14. What does SpO2 measure? Roughly what is normal?
15. Expand PTB.
16. What is BPH?
17. Expand DVT and say why surgeons worry about it.
18. Spell: haemorrhoids, dyspnoea, oesophageal.
19. What is the difference between type 1 and type 2 diabetes?
20. Spell five terms your partner dictates.
21. A 45-year-old caller has had a cough for five weeks and has lost weight. Which specialist do you book?
22. A caller has central chest pain now and is sweating. What do you do and say?

Week 3: The body by system II

This week's systems are the ones our clients sell. Every table names the client where you will meet the language.

3.1 Bones and joints (musculoskeletal, orthopaedics)

- Where you meet it: Osteon Clinics (Dr Bola Akinola), joint replacement, OrthoSurplus implants.
- Specialists: orthopaedic surgeon; rheumatologist (medical joint disease); physiotherapist.

Term	Meaning
Osteoarthritis (OA)	Wear of the joint cartilage. The main reason for knee and hip replacement.
Rheumatoid arthritis (RA)	Autoimmune joint inflammation
Total knee replacement (TKR, TKA)	The knee joint surfaces replaced with an implant. TKA is total knee arthroplasty.
Total hip replacement (THR, THA)	The same for the hip

Term	Meaning
Arthroplasty	Joint replacement surgery in general
Arthroscopy	Keyhole surgery inside a joint
Fracture (#, Fx)	A broken bone. Doctors write # for fracture.
ORIF	Open reduction and internal fixation: opening, realigning and fixing a fracture with plates or screws
Implant	The device placed in the body: plates, screws, joint components
Physiotherapy	Rehabilitation by exercise and movement. Essential after joint replacement.

3.2 Brain and nerves (neurology, neurosurgery)

- Specialists: neurologist (medical); neurosurgeon (surgical).

Term	Meaning
Epilepsy, seizure	Recurrent fits, a single fit
Glasgow Coma Scale (GCS)	Score of consciousness from 3 (deeply unconscious) to 15 (fully alert)
Head injury	Common after road traffic crashes (RTA, RTC)
Meningitis	Infection of the lining of the brain
Peripheral neuropathy	Nerve damage, usually in the feet, common in diabetes
EEG	Electroencephalogram, recording of brain electrical activity

3.3 Women's health (obstetrics and gynaecology)

- Where you meet it: Arabella Women's Health (Dr Chito Nwana), Clearview Fertility (Dr Kunle Ajayi).
- Specialists: obstetrician and gynaecologist (O&G); fertility specialist (reproductive endocrinologist); midwife.

Term	Meaning
Antenatal care (ANC)	Care during pregnancy
Gravida, para (G2P1)	Number of pregnancies, number of births past the age of viability (28 weeks in most Nigerian hospitals). G2P1 means two pregnancies, one birth.
LMP, EDD	Last menstrual period; expected date of delivery
Gestational age (GA)	Weeks of pregnancy. Careful: GA also means general anaesthesia.
SVD	Spontaneous vaginal delivery
Caesarean section (CS, LSCS)	Delivery by operation. LSCS is lower segment caesarean section.
Pre-eclampsia (PET, PIH)	High blood pressure in pregnancy with organ effects. PIH is pregnancy-induced hypertension.

Term	Meaning
Postpartum haemorrhage (PPH)	Heavy bleeding after birth. A leading cause of maternal death in Nigeria.
Fibroids (uterine leiomyoma)	Benign growths in the uterus. Very common in Nigerian women.
Myomectomy	Removal of fibroids, keeping the uterus
Hysterectomy	Removal of the uterus
Infertility	Not conceiving after 12 months of trying
IVF, ICSI	In vitro fertilisation; intracytoplasmic sperm injection, one sperm injected into each egg
Embryo transfer (ET)	Placing the embryo in the uterus during IVF
HSG	Hysterosalpingogram, an X-ray of the uterus and tubes
Menopause	The end of periods

3.4 Children and newborns (paediatrics, neonatology)

- Where you meet it: Haven Paediatric Centre, its NICU.
- Specialists: paediatrician; neonatologist; paediatric surgeon.

Term	Meaning
Neonate	A baby in its first 28 days
NICU, SCBU	Neonatal intensive care unit; special care baby unit (lower level)
Preterm, prematurity	Born before 37 weeks
Low birth weight (LBW)	Under 2.5 kg at birth
Neonatal jaundice (NNJ)	Yellowing in newborns. Treated with phototherapy; severe cases need exchange blood transfusion.
Birth asphyxia	Lack of oxygen at birth
Neonatal sepsis	Serious infection in a newborn
Respiratory distress syndrome (RDS)	Breathing difficulty in preterm babies
CPAP	Continuous positive airway pressure, breathing support
Incubator	Warm enclosed cot for small or sick babies
Kangaroo mother care (KMC)	Skin-to-skin care for small babies
Immunisation	Vaccines on the national schedule

3.5 Skin, aesthetics and plastic surgery

- Where you meet it: Belfiore Medical Aesthetics (Dr Uju Rapu), Lyfe Plastics and Aesthetics (Dr Chinwe Kpaduwa), the AGELESS evening.
- Specialists: dermatologist (skin disease); plastic surgeon (reconstructive and cosmetic surgery); aesthetic physician (non-surgical treatments).
- The distinction matters to clients: a plastic surgeon operates; an aesthetic physician injects and uses devices; a dermatologist treats skin disease. Do not use the titles interchangeably.

Term	Meaning
Botulinum toxin	Injection that relaxes muscles to soften lines. Known by brand names; use the generic in our documents.
Dermal filler	Injected gel, usually hyaluronic acid, to restore volume
Liposuction	Removing fat by suction
Abdominoplasty	Tummy tuck
Rhinoplasty	Reshaping the nose
Mastopexy, augmentation, reduction	Breast lift, enlargement, reduction
BBL	Brazilian butt lift, fat transfer to the buttocks. A high-risk procedure.
Chemical peel	Acid applied to remove damaged skin layers
Hyperpigmentation	Dark patches of skin
Keloid	Raised overgrown scar, more common in dark skin. A real risk to discuss before any cut.

3.6 Cancer (oncology)

- Where you meet it: Solace Healthcare, Pearl Oncology.
- Specialists: medical oncologist (drug treatment); clinical or radiation oncologist (radiotherapy); surgical oncologist.

Term	Meaning
Tumour, benign, malignant	A growth; not cancer; cancer
Metastasis	Spread of cancer to other parts of the body
Biopsy	Removing tissue to examine under a microscope
Histology	The laboratory examination of that tissue
Staging	How far the cancer has spread, usually stage 1 to 4
Chemotherapy	Cancer drugs, usually given in cycles
Radiotherapy	Radiation treatment
Day case	Treatment where the patient goes home the same day, as with most chemotherapy

Term	Meaning
Palliative care	Care focused on comfort when cure is not possible

3.7 Mind and addiction (psychiatry)

- Where you meet it: House of Refuge (Freedom Foundation).
- Specialists: psychiatrist (a doctor, prescribes); clinical psychologist (therapy, does not prescribe).

Term	Meaning
Substance use disorder	Addiction to alcohol or drugs
Detoxification (detox)	Medically supervised withdrawal
Rehabilitation (rehab)	Longer programme of recovery after detox
Depression, anxiety	Common mood disorders
Psychosis	Losing touch with reality

3.8 Exercise 3

For each client below, write one line: the specialty, the specialist's correct title, and two procedures or services it sells, in correct clinical language.

Arabella, Haven, Osteon, Belfiore, Clearview, Solace, Dennis Ashley, House of Refuge.

On the Mezo line: matching to a specialist, system II

Caller's need	Book
Knee or hip pain, fracture follow-up	Orthopaedic surgeon
Swollen painful joints in several places	Rheumatologist
Headaches, fits, numbness	Neurologist
Pregnancy care	Obstetrician
Fibroids, irregular or painful periods	Gynaecologist
Trying to conceive for a year or more	Fertility specialist. Both partners should be seen; the man may also need a urologist.
A child's illness	Paediatrician
Rash, acne, skin disease	Dermatologist
Cosmetic surgery	Plastic surgeon
Injectables, skin treatments	Aesthetic physician
A breast lump	Breast or general surgeon, as soon as possible
Eyes	Ophthalmologist

Caller's need	Book
Ear, nose, throat	ENT surgeon (otorhinolaryngologist)
Drinking or drug use	The addiction admissions team, or a psychiatrist
Low mood, anxiety	Psychiatrist or clinical psychologist. Any mention of self-harm: Safety Card, section 2.

3.9 Test 3

1. What is the difference between TKR and THR?
2. Expand ORIF.
3. What do doctors mean when they write #?
4. What does a GCS of 15 mean?
5. What does G3P2 mean?
6. Expand LSCS.
7. Expand PPH. Why does it matter in Nigeria?
8. What is the difference between a myomectomy and a hysterectomy?
9. What is ICSI?
10. Up to what age is a baby a neonate?
11. What is the difference between a NICU and a SCBU?
12. What is the treatment for most neonatal jaundice?
13. What is the difference between a plastic surgeon and an aesthetic physician?
14. What is a keloid, and why is it discussed before surgery?
15. What is the difference between benign and malignant?
16. What is metastasis?
17. What is the difference between a psychiatrist and a clinical psychologist?
18. GA has two meanings. Give both.
19. Spell: gynaecology, orthopaedics, haemorrhage, anaesthesia.
20. Spell five terms your partner dictates.
21. A couple has been trying to conceive for 18 months. Who do you book, and who should be seen?
22. A mother says her six-week-old baby has a fever and is not feeding well. What do you do?

Week 4: Who does what, and how they write it down

4.1 Doctors

Grade	What it means
House officer (HO)	One-year internship after medical school, required before full registration with MDCN
Medical officer (MO)	A fully registered doctor not in specialist training. Most private hospital doctors are MOs.

Grade	What it means
Resident doctor: registrar, senior registrar	Doctors in specialist training in a teaching hospital
Consultant	A fully trained specialist. In private practice, the consultant usually brings the patients.
Fellow (FWACS, FMCS, FWACP, FMCP and others)	The postgraduate qualification of a consultant, from the West African College or the National Postgraduate Medical College
Medical director (MD)	The doctor who runs the hospital clinically. Often also its owner.
Chief medical director (CMD)	Title of the head of a federal teaching or medical centre

- Address: Dr and surname unless told otherwise. A professor is Professor. A consultant surgeon may prefer Mr or Mrs in the UK tradition; follow what they sign.

4.2 Everyone else

Role	What they do
Nurse, nursing officer	Ward and clinic care. Grades rise to chief nursing officer; the head is often the director of nursing or matron.
Midwife	Pregnancy and birth care. Many Nigerian nurses are dual qualified (RN, RM).
Pharmacist	Dispenses and checks medicines. Registered with the Pharmacy Council of Nigeria (PCN).
Medical laboratory scientist	Runs lab tests. Registered with MLSCN.
Radiographer	Takes X-rays and scans. The radiologist (a doctor) reports them.
Physiotherapist	Rehabilitation
Anaesthetist	Doctor who gives anaesthesia. Nurse anaesthetists also work in many Nigerian hospitals.
Health records officer	Keeps patient files and coding
Community health extension worker (CHEW)	Primary care worker in public facilities

4.3 Departments and units

Unit	Meaning
OPD	Outpatient department, the clinics
A&E, emergency	Accident and emergency
Ward, IPD	Inpatient beds
ICU, HDU	Intensive care unit; high dependency unit, one step down
Theatre, OT	Operating theatre

Unit	Meaning
Labour ward	Where women deliver
Lab, pathology	Laboratory
Radiology, imaging	X-ray, ultrasound, CT, MRI
Pharmacy	Medicines
HMO desk	Where insured patients' authorisation is handled

4.4 The documents

Document	What it is
Case note, folder	The patient's record. Each visit adds an entry.
Clerking	The first full history and examination when a patient is admitted
SOAP note	A common entry format: Subjective (what the patient says), Objective (what is found), Assessment (the diagnosis), Plan
Referral letter	One doctor asking another to see a patient
Discharge summary	What happened during the admission, the diagnosis, medicines, and follow-up
Consent form	The patient's written agreement to a procedure, after the risks are explained
Operation note	What the surgeon did
Treatment chart, drug chart	Medicines given, by time and nurse
Death certificate, medical certificate of cause of death	Formal record of a death

4.5 Shorthand in case notes

Abbreviation	Meaning
c/o	Complains of
HPC, Hx	History of presenting complaint; history
PMH	Past medical history
O/E	On examination
NAD	No abnormality detected
Dx, DDx	Diagnosis; differential diagnosis (the list of possibilities)
Rx, Tx	Treatment, prescription
Ix	Investigations
F/U, R/V	Follow-up; review

Abbreviation	Meaning
BP, HR, RR, T	Blood pressure, heart rate, respiratory rate, temperature: the vital signs
DAMA	Discharged against medical advice. Common in Nigerian hospitals, often for money reasons.
BID	Brought in dead
NBM, NPO	Nil by mouth, nothing to eat or drink, usually before surgery
RTA, RTC	Road traffic accident, road traffic crash

4.6 Prescription shorthand

Abbreviation	Meaning
OD	Once daily. Also means right eye, which is why some hospitals ban it.
BD	Twice daily
TDS	Three times daily
QDS	Four times daily
PRN	As needed
Stat	Immediately, once
Nocte, mane	At night, in the morning
PO	By mouth
IV, IM, SC	Into a vein, into a muscle, under the skin
PR, PV, SL	Rectally, vaginally, under the tongue
mg, mcg, g	Milligram, microgram, gram

- Never write U for units or IU: it is misread as a zero. Write "units".
- Never write a trailing zero (5.0 mg can be read as 50 mg) and always write a leading zero (0.5 mg, not .5 mg).
- You will not write prescriptions. You will minute meetings and draft documents where these appear, and an error in a document about a medicine is a safety error.

4.7 A discharge summary to decode

Patient: Mrs A.B., 46 yrs. Adm: 12/10. D/C: 15/10.

c/o: heavy menstrual bleeding x 8/12, dizziness. PMH: HTN on amlodipine 5mg OD.

O/E: pale, BP 150/95, PR 102. Abdo: pelvic mass ~20/52 size.

Ix: Hb 7.2 g/dL, PCV 22%. Pelvic USS: multiple uterine fibroids, largest 9 cm.

Dx: symptomatic uterine fibroids with anaemia.

Rx: transfused 2 units blood. Abdominal myomectomy 14/10 under GA. EBL 800 ml.

D/C meds: ferrous sulphate 200mg TDS x 3/12, amlodipine 5mg OD, paracetamol 1g QDS PRN.

F/U: gynae OPD 2/52 for wound review and histology.

- Adm and D/C are admission and discharge. PR here is pulse rate, not rectally: context decides.
- "x 8/12" means for eight months. "2/52" means in two weeks. "/7" is days, "/52" weeks, "/12" months.
- In pregnancy, "34/40" means 34 weeks of a 40-week pregnancy.
- "~20/52 size" means the uterus was the size of a 20-week pregnancy.
- EBL is estimated blood loss.

4.8 Exercise 4

Rewrite the discharge summary above as a plain-English paragraph a family member could understand. Then list every abbreviation in it with its expansion. Then say what follow-up the hospital needs to book and when.

On the Mezo line: the note to the doctor

Before every visit the doctor gets a short note from you. It saves the first ten minutes of the consultation.

Line	Example
Patient	Mrs O., 52F, Abuja
Complaint, own words	"My knees are paining me, I can't climb stairs"
Clinical terms, duration	Bilateral knee pain x 2/12, worse on stairs
Known conditions	Known hypertensive
Medicines	Amlodipine 5mg OD
Allergies	None known (NKDA)
Previous results	Knee X-ray from 2025, bringing it
Payer	HMO: plan and enrollee number, code requested
Red flags screened	Yes, none
Consent to share	Given on call, 3 Nov

- Ask every patient to bring: previous results and scans, their medicines or the packs, their HMO card, any referral letter.
- NKDA means no known drug allergies.

4.9 Test 4

1. What is a house officer?
2. What is the difference between a medical officer and a consultant?
3. What is a senior registrar?
4. Who reports an X-ray: the radiographer or the radiologist?
5. What is the difference between ICU and HDU?
6. What does SOAP stand for?
7. What is a clerking?
8. Expand c/o, O/E and NAD.
9. What is DAMA, and why is it common?
10. What does NBM mean and when is it used?
11. Expand BD, TDS and QDS.
12. What does PRN mean?
13. Why should "U" never be written for units?
14. Why is 5.0 mg dangerous to write?
15. What does "x 3/12" mean in a case note?
16. What does "F/U 2/52" mean?
17. What are the four vital signs abbreviated as BP, HR, RR, T?
18. What is a differential diagnosis?
19. Which council registers pharmacists in Nigeria?
20. Spell five terms your partner dictates.
21. List eight things your note to the doctor must carry.
22. A caller asks whether to stop their blood pressure tablets before seeing the cardiologist. What do you say?

Week 5: Tests, scans, theatre and procedures

5.1 Laboratory tests

Test	What it measures	Notes
FBC	Full blood count: haemoglobin, white cells, platelets	The most common blood test
Hb, PCV	Haemoglobin; packed cell volume	Both measure anaemia. PCV is widely used in Nigeria.
WBC	White blood cells	High in infection
E/U/Cr	Electrolytes, urea and creatinine	Kidney function and body salts
LFT	Liver function tests	
Lipid profile	Cholesterol and fats	Heart risk

Test	What it measures	Notes
FBS, RBS, HbA1c	Blood sugar	Diabetes
Urinalysis (U/A)	Dipstick test of urine	
M/C/S	Microscopy, culture and sensitivity	Grows the organism and shows which antibiotics work. Takes 48 to 72 hours.
MP, RDT	Malaria parasite film; rapid diagnostic test	
Widal	Old typhoid test	Unreliable and over-used in Nigeria. Many good labs no longer rely on it.
HIV, RVS	HIV test. RVS is retroviral screening.	Done with consent and confidentiality
HBsAg, HCV	Hepatitis B and C screening	Routine before surgery
Genotype, blood group	Haemoglobin type; ABO and Rhesus group	Before transfusion and in pregnancy
PT/INR	Clotting	Before surgery, and on blood thinners
Histology	Tissue under the microscope	After a biopsy or removal of a mass
Pap smear	Cervical screening	Cervical cancer prevention
PSA	Prostate specific antigen	Prostate screening

5.2 Imaging

Test	What it is	Notes
X-ray, CXR	Radiograph; chest X-ray	Bones and chest. Uses radiation.
Ultrasound (USS)	Sound waves	Pregnancy, abdomen, pelvis. No radiation.
CT	Computed tomography	Detailed X-ray slices. Fast, good for head injury.
MRI	Magnetic resonance imaging	Soft tissue, brain, spine, joints. No radiation; slow and expensive.
Mammogram	Breast X-ray	Screening
Doppler	Ultrasound of blood flow	Clots, pregnancy

5.3 Theatre

Term	Meaning
Elective	Planned in advance
Emergency	Cannot wait

Term	Meaning
Day case	Home the same day
Major, minor	By size and risk of the operation
General anaesthesia (GA)	Fully asleep
Regional anaesthesia: spinal, epidural	Numb from a part of the body down, awake. Most caesareans are under spinal.
Local anaesthesia (LA)	Only a small area numbed
Sedation	Drowsy but breathing on their own. Used for endoscopy.
Theatre list	The day's planned operations, in order
Pre-op assessment	Checks before surgery: history, bloods, fitness for anaesthesia
Recovery, PACU	Where patients wake up
Laparoscopic, keyhole, minimally invasive	Surgery through small cuts with a camera
Open surgery	Through a full incision
Surgical site infection (SSI)	Wound infection after surgery. A core quality measure.
WHO surgical safety checklist	The three-pause checklist before, during and after an operation

5.4 Procedures you will hear about at our clients

Procedure	Client context
Upper GI endoscopy, colonoscopy	Dennis Ashley endoscopy suites
LSCS, myomectomy, hysterectomy, hysteroscopy	Arabella
IVF, ICSI, embryo transfer, egg retrieval	Clearview
TKR, THR, arthroscopy, ORIF	Osteon
Phototherapy, exchange blood transfusion, CPAP	Haven NICU
Botulinum toxin, filler, liposuction, abdominoplasty	Belfiore, Lyfe
Chemotherapy, biopsy	Solace

5.5 A theatre list to decode

> Theatre 1, Thursday. Surgeon: Dr X. Anaesthetist: Dr Y.
>
> 1. 58F, R knee OA. R TKR. Spinal. Implant confirmed.
> 2. 34F, G0P0, fibroids. Lap myomectomy. GA. 2 units X-matched.
> 3. 41M, # L radius. ORIF. GA. Day case.

- 58F means a 58-year-old woman. R and L are right and left. Lap is laparoscopic. X-matched is cross-matched, meaning blood is tested and ready.

5.6 Exercise 5

Decode the theatre list above in full sentences. Then say for each case what the hospital must have ready before the patient arrives (for example: the implant in the building and checked, blood cross-matched, a bed in recovery).

On the Mezo line: preparing the patient

Booked for	Tell the patient (confirm with the facility)
Fasting blood sugar, lipid profile	Usually nothing to eat from the night before, 8 to 12 hours. Water is fine.
Surgery	Follow the hospital's nil by mouth instructions exactly. Ask whether to take usual medicines that morning.
MRI	Tell us about any pacemaker, metal implant or metal fragments before the booking. Some cannot have an MRI.
CT with contrast	The facility may need kidney function results and will ask about allergies
Pelvic ultrasound	May need a full bladder; the facility will say
Colonoscopy	Bowel preparation the day before, from the facility; someone to take them home after sedation
Any sedation or day case	An adult to take them home; no driving that day

A surgery quote: what it must contain

- Surgeon's fee, anaesthetist's fee, theatre fee.
- Implant or device, if any, and who supplies it.
- Bed days, feeding, nursing.
- Drugs and consumables.
- Pre-operative tests.
- What is not included, and what happens if the stay is longer.
- Never send a quote the facility and doctor have not confirmed.

5.7 Test 5

1. What does an FBC measure?
2. What does E/U/Cr test?
3. What does M/C/S stand for, and why does it take two to three days?
4. Why is the Widal test considered unreliable?
5. Which tests are routine before surgery for infection screening?
6. What does PT/INR measure?
7. What is histology?
8. Which imaging test uses no radiation and is used in pregnancy?
9. What is the difference between CT and MRI?

10. What is the difference between elective and emergency surgery?
11. What is a day case?
12. What is the difference between general and spinal anaesthesia?
13. What type of anaesthesia is used for most caesarean sections?
14. What does "lap" mean on a theatre list?
15. What does "X-matched" mean?
16. What is an SSI?
17. What does 72M mean in a case note?
18. Name two procedures done at an endoscopy suite.
19. Spell: laparoscopic, cholecystectomy, haematology, colonoscopy.
20. Spell five terms your partner dictates.
21. A patient booked for a fasting lipid profile asks if they can have breakfast. What do you say?
22. A patient with a pacemaker is booked for an MRI. What do you do?

Week 6: How a patient moves and how money moves

6.1 The outpatient journey

Step	What happens	Where money moves
Registration	Folder opened, details taken	Card or registration fee. HMO patients show their card.
Triage, vitals	Nurse checks BP, temperature, weight	
Consultation	Doctor sees the patient	Consultation fee, or HMO bills it
Investigations	Lab and imaging ordered	Paid before the sample is taken in most private hospitals. HMO patients may need an authorisation code.
Review	Doctor reads results, decides	Review fee
Pharmacy	Medicines dispensed	Paid at the pharmacy. HMO formulary limits what is covered.
Follow-up or referral	Next appointment, or sent elsewhere	

6.2 The inpatient journey

Step	What happens	Where money moves
Decision to admit	From OPD or A&E	Deposit demanded from cash patients. Authorisation code from the HMO.
Admission, clerking	Bed allocated, full history	Bed per day, feeding, nursing
Treatment, surgery	Procedures, theatre, drugs	Theatre fee, surgeon's fee, anaesthetist's fee, consumables, implants

Step	What happens	Where money moves
Daily ward round	Consultant reviews	Daily consultant fee in many hospitals
Discharge	Summary, medicines, bill	Final bill settled before the patient leaves. Disputes and DAMA happen here.
Claim	Hospital bills the HMO	Payment comes weeks or months later. Rejections and underpayments are common.

6.3 Payers in one line each

- Out of pocket: the patient or family pays cash. Still the majority of private hospital revenue in Nigeria.
- HMO: a health maintenance organisation manages insurance for employers. The hospital is paid a capitation (a fixed amount per enrollee per month for primary care) or fee-for-service against a tariff, after an authorisation code for anything significant.
- NHIA: the National Health Insurance Authority, which replaced the NHIS in 2022. Write NHIA, not NHIS.
- State schemes: for example the Lagos State scheme run by LASHMA.
- Corporate retainers: a company pays the hospital directly for its staff.
- Diaspora: family abroad paying for care at home.

C4, The Nigerian Health Market, goes into each of these. For now, know the words.

6.4 Quality and governance words

Term	Meaning
Clinical governance	The system that keeps clinical care safe and improving
Morbidity and mortality (M&M) meeting	Doctors review complications and deaths to learn from them
Incident report	Written record of something that went wrong or nearly did
Clinical audit	Checking practice against a standard
Accreditation	External certification of quality, for example SafeCare in Nigeria
Standard operating procedure (SOP)	The written way a task is done
Infection prevention and control (IPC)	Hand hygiene, sterilisation, isolation
Informed consent	Agreement after the risks are explained
Medical negligence	Care below the accepted standard that causes harm

6.5 Metrics vocabulary

Term	Meaning
Bed occupancy	Share of beds filled, on average

Term	Meaning
ALOS	Average length of stay, in days
Throughput	Patients through a unit in a period
Theatre utilisation	Share of available theatre time used
Conversion	Share of consultations that turn into a procedure or admission
Payer mix	Share of revenue from cash, HMO, NHIA and others
Debtor days	How long the hospital waits to be paid, mostly by HMOs

6.6 Exercise 6

Pick one client: Ezinne, Arabella; Abigail, Haven. From the engagement record, map a typical patient's journey from first contact to discharge or follow-up in a table like 6.1 or 6.2. For each step note who the patient deals with, and how money is collected. Mark anything you guessed as a guess.

On the Mezo line: payer, fee and follow-up

Payer	Before booking
HMO	Plan name and enrollee number; whether this specialist and facility accept that plan; whether an authorisation code is needed before the visit, and who requests it; what the plan does not cover
Cash	The full fee confirmed with the caller before any payment. That is Mezo's promise.
Family abroad paying	Who is paying, how, and the patient's consent to what the payer is told

- After the visit: call within two working days. Was the patient seen? Do they know the next step? Is a follow-up or test to be booked? Record it.
- Close the loop: the request is not finished when the appointment is booked. It is finished when the patient has been seen and the next step is arranged.

6.7 Test 6

1. At which step in a private hospital is a cash deposit usually demanded?
2. What is an authorisation code, and who issues it?
3. What is capitation?
4. What replaced the NHIS, and in what year?
5. What does LASHMA run?
6. What is the difference between fee-for-service and capitation?
7. What happens at an M&M meeting?
8. What is an incident report?
9. What is SafeCare?
10. What is clinical audit?
11. What is ALOS?

12. What does bed occupancy measure?
13. What is payer mix?
14. Why do hospitals with many HMO patients often run short of cash?
15. What is conversion, in a clinic?
16. What is IPC?
17. What is informed consent?
18. In the inpatient journey, when are theatre, surgeon's and anaesthetist's fees charged?
19. Spell: accreditation, haemodialysis, gynaecological, anaesthetist.
20. Spell five terms your partner dictates.
21. A patient on an HMO plan wants to see a gynaecologist. What three things do you confirm before booking?
22. A daughter calling from London asks for her mother's test results. What do you do?

The exam: Thursday 7 January 2027

Written paper

- 60 questions, 45 minutes, closed book, drawn from all six weeks.
- Includes one clinical document to decode in full.

Oral, with Dr Okeleye, 20 minutes each

- Read aloud a short clinical letter you have not seen, and explain it in plain English.
- Spell ten terms Dr Okeleye dictates. The floor is eight of ten.
- Explain one client's clinical service in two minutes, as you would to an investor.
- Show your glossary. Dr Okeleye picks ten terms at random to check.

Revising

- Repeat every weekly test, closed book, between 21 December and 6 January.
- Finish the glossary to 400 terms.
- Keep doing the pair drill. Spelling is where marks are lost.